ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

UNIVERSITY · 1ST YEAR

COMPUTER LITERACY

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE A · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 100

Marking guideline for the Academic Central University · 1st year Computer Literacy paper 1 · practice a.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following first-year computer literacy (end-user computing) syllabuses at South African universities. It is not a university memorandum.

How to mark: each ✓ is one mark. Accept answers in the student's own words if the meaning is correct, and any other correct example. For formulas, accept equivalent correct formulas (e.g. 0.2*B2 or B2*20%), with or without spaces, in upper or lower case.

QUESTION 1

1.1 C ✓
1.2 B ✓
1.3 B ✓
1.4 A ✓
1.5 B ✓
1.6 B ✓
1.7 C ✓
1.8 A ✓
1.9 B ✓
1.10 B ✓
1.11 B ✓
1.12 B ✓
1.13 A ✓
1.14 A ✓
1.15 B ✓

(15)

[15]

QUESTION 2

2.1 TRUE ✓
2.2 TRUE ✓
2.3 TRUE ✓
2.4 FALSE ✓
2.5 FALSE ✓
2.6 TRUE ✓
2.7 FALSE ✓
2.8 FALSE ✓
2.9 TRUE ✓
2.10 TRUE ✓

(10)

[10]

QUESTION 3

3.1 Hardware is the physical parts of a computer that you can touch ✓, e.g. keyboard, monitor, CPU ✓
Software is the programs and instructions that tell the hardware what to do ✓, e.g. Windows, Word, a web browser ✓ (4)

3.2 Primary storage (main memory) is used by the CPU while it works and is fast but mostly temporary ✓, e.g. RAM ✓
Secondary storage keeps data permanently, even when the power is off ✓, e.g. hard drive, SSD, flash drive ✓ (4)

3.3 Any TWO: manages memory and the CPU (processes) ✓; manages files and folders ✓; controls input and output devices (drivers); provides the user interface; handles security and user accounts (2)

3.4 Open-source software's source code is freely available to use, change and share ✓; proprietary software is owned by a company, its code is secret and it usually needs a paid licence ✓ (2)

3.5 Any THREE with a reason: processor (CPU) speed, for how fast programs run ✓; RAM size, for running several programs smoothly ✓; storage size and type (SSD), for space and speed ✓; battery life, for working away from a plug; weight and size, for carrying to campus; screen size; ports and Wi-Fi (3)

[15]

QUESTION 4

4.1 File name: Assignment1 ✓ Extension: .docx ✓ (2)

4.2 Assignments ✓ (1)

4.3 It is a Microsoft Word document (it shows the file type and which program opens it) ✓ (1)

4.4 Save stores changes to the existing file under the same name and place ✓; Save As lets you choose a new name, location or file type, creating a new copy ✓ (2)

4.5 Compression makes a file or group of files smaller by packing them into one file (e.g. .zip) ✓. Reason, any ONE: to send it by email faster; to save storage space; to upload or download faster; to keep many files together ✓ (2)

4.6 Any TWO: use short, meaningful names ✓; include a date or version number ✓; avoid special characters such as / \ : * ? " < > |; be consistent; do not use spaces at the start (2)

[10]

QUESTION 5

5.1 The internet is the worldwide network of connected computers (the hardware and connections) ✓; the World Wide Web is the collection of web pages and sites that we reach through the internet ✓ (2)

5.2 Any TWO: share files and printers ✓; share one internet connection ✓; central backups and software updates; users can log in on any computer; communication between users (2)

5.3 It connects different networks and directs (routes) data between them, e.g. between the home network and the internet ✓ (1)

5.4 Bandwidth is the amount of data that can be sent over a connection per second ✓. If the bandwidth is too low, the video data cannot arrive as fast as it is played, so the player must stop and wait (buffer) ✓ (2)

5.5.1 Any THREE: the sender's address is not a university address ✓; it creates urgency or a threat ("closed today", "within 2 hours") ✓; it asks for your password ✓; the link goes to a strange website that is not the university's and is not https; spelling and grammar mistakes ("you're account"); generic greeting "Dear Student" (3)

5.5.2 Do not click the link or reply; delete it or report it to the real IT helpdesk ✓ (1)

5.6 Any TWO: at least 8 to 12 characters long ✓; a mix of upper and lower case letters, numbers and symbols ✓; not a real word or personal information; different for every account (2)

5.7 Logging in needs two different proofs of identity ✓, e.g. a password plus a code sent to your phone ✓ (2)

5.8 Malware is malicious software made to harm a computer, steal data or take control of it ✓. Any TWO types: virus ✓; worm ✓; trojan horse; ransomware; spyware; adware (3)

5.9 Any ONE: collect only the information it needs; keep it safe and secure; use it only for the reason it was collected; not share it without consent; let students see and correct their information ✓ (1)

5.10 Any ONE: be polite and respectful; use a clear subject line and greeting; do not type in capital letters (shouting); stay on topic; do not share other people's information or offensive content ✓ (1)

[20]

QUESTION 6

6.1 =B2*0.2+C2*0.2+D2*0.6 equals sign and correct cells ✓; correct weights ✓; correct operators ✓ (3)

0.2 × 65 = 13 and 0.2 × 72 = 14.4 ✓

0.6 × 58 = 34.8 ✓

13 + 14.4 + 34.8 = 62.2 ✓

(3)

6.3 =IF(E2>=50,"Pass","Fail") IF function ✓; condition E2>=50 ✓; both results in quotes in the right order ✓ (3)

6.4 =AVERAGE(B2:B6) function ✓; range ✓ (2)

6.5 =COUNTIF(F2:F6,"Pass") function ✓; range and criterion ✓ (2)

6.6 =MAX(D2:D6) ✓ (1)

6.7 =B2*B10+C2*C10+D2*D10 uses B10, C10 and D10 ✓; absolute references for the weight cells ✓; relative references for the marks ✓ (3)

6.8 A column (or bar) chart ✓, because it compares separate values (one bar per student) side by side ✓ (2)

6.9 D4 ✓ (1)

[20]

QUESTION 7

7.1.1 Table of contents ✓ (1)

7.1.2 Header ✓ (1)

7.1.3 Page break ✓ (1)

7.1.4 Spelling and grammar check (spell check) ✓ (1)

7.2 A citation shows in the text where an idea or quote comes from, and the reference list gives the full details of every source at the end ✓. They give credit to the authors and avoid plagiarism, and let the reader find the sources ✓ (2)

7.3 Any FOUR: few words per slide (key points only) ✓; large, readable font ✓; good contrast between text and background ✓; one main idea per slide ✓; use relevant pictures or charts; consistent design or theme; limit animations and transitions; check spelling (4)

[10]

TOTAL: 100

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE